

Enhancements - Time & Attendance Module

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In most HR/employee experience platforms, **Leave Management** and **Time & Attendance** are usually **separate modules that are tightly integrated** rather than a single module.

Why they're different

Leave Management	Time & Attendance
Leave requests and approvals	Clock-in/clock-out
Vacation, sick leave, maternity leave	Shift schedules
Leave balances and accruals	Work hours tracking
Holiday calendars	Overtime calculation
Leave policies	Attendance compliance
Leave reporting	Timesheets

For example, if an employee takes approved leave, that information automatically updates attendance records so the employee isn't marked absent.

What do leading HR systems do?

Platforms such as Workday, SAP SuccessFactors, Oracle Fusion HCM, and UKG Pro generally treat them as distinct functional areas while sharing common employee, policy, and workflow data.

A common hierarchy is:

Workforce Management
├── Time & Attendance
├── Leave Management
├── Scheduling
└── Overtime Management

For an Employee Experience Portal: What is better?

Option 1: Separate modules (recommended for medium/large organizations)

Navigation

My Work
└─ Attendance
└─ Leave

Pros

- Clear ownership and business processes.
- Easier to support complex attendance rules.
- Easier reporting and analytics.
- Scales well for shift workers, factories, retail, healthcare, etc.

Best for

- 500+ employees
 - Multiple geographies
 - Shift-based workforce
 - Complex compliance requirements
-

Option 2: Single "Time Off & Attendance" module (good for simpler organizations)**Navigation**

Attendance & Leave
└─ Check In/Out
└─ My Timesheet
└─ Request Leave
└─ Leave Balance

Pros

- Simpler user experience.
- Fewer menu items.
- Employees think about both together ("Am I working today or not?").

Cons

- Can become cluttered as requirements grow.
- Harder to separate workflows and permissions later.

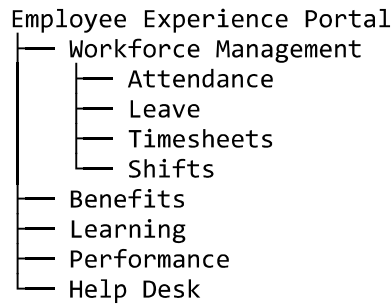
Best for

- Small and mid-sized companies
 - Office-based workforce
 - MVP or initial product release
-

My recommendation for an Employee Experience Portal

Use **separate backend modules** but present them under a single **Workforce Management** area in the portal.

Example:



This gives you:

- Clean architecture
- Independent evolution of each capability
- Better reporting and integrations
- A simple employee-facing experience

For a modern EX portal, I'd model them as **two modules within the same Workforce Management domain**, not as one combined module. This is the approach most enterprise HCM platforms follow.

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In an Employee Experience (EX) portal, **Benefits** refers to all the non-salary programs, entitlements, and perks that employees receive from the employer.

Typical Benefits functionality includes:

Core Benefits

- Health insurance
- Life insurance
- Accident insurance
- Disability coverage
- Retirement/pension plans
- Provident fund and gratuity information (in India)

Financial Benefits

- Flexible benefits plans
- Reimbursement claims
 - Internet reimbursement
 - Mobile reimbursement

- Fuel/travel reimbursement
- Wellness reimbursement
- Meal cards or food allowances
- Stock options (ESOPs/RSUs)

Wellbeing Benefits

- Wellness programs
- Mental health support
- Employee assistance programs (EAP)
- Gym memberships
- Health checkups

Employee Perks

- Discounts and offers
 - Corporate partnerships
 - Learning budgets
 - Certification sponsorships
 - Employee referral rewards
-

In an EX Portal

Employees usually use the Benefits module to:

- View available benefits
- Enroll in benefit plans
- Add or update dependents
- Download insurance cards/documents
- Submit reimbursement claims
- Track claim status
- View benefit utilization

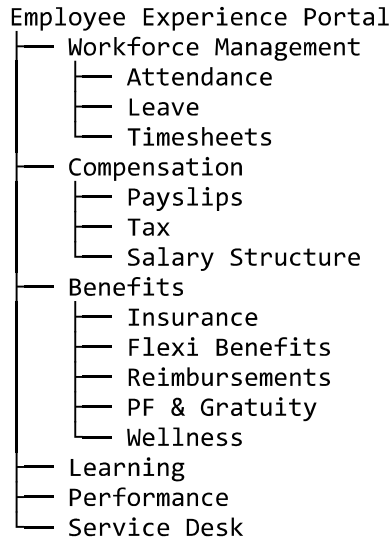
Example:

Benefits

- Insurance
 - Reimbursements
 - Retirement & PF
 - Wellness
 - Perks & Discounts
 - Claims & Documents
-

For an Indian enterprise portal

A common structure would be:



One design nuance: many organizations place **reimbursements** under Benefits, while others place them under **Finance/Expenses**. If your portal will also handle travel expenses and corporate card expenses, it's usually cleaner to create a separate **Expenses** module rather than putting everything under Benefits.

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For timesheetss, design around **capabilities** and make industry-specific features configurable.

The biggest mistake HR products make is trying to force every customer into the same workforce model.

Start with workforce archetypes, not industries

Industries differ, but workforce patterns are often similar.

Archetype 1: Office / Knowledge Workers

Examples:

- Software
- Consulting
- Corporate functions

Needs:

- Leave
- Attendance (sometimes optional)
- Timesheets (project/client billing)
- Remote work tracking

Archetype 2: Shift Workers

Examples:

- Manufacturing
- Retail
- Healthcare
- Warehousing

Needs:

- Rosters
- Shift assignments
- Clock in/out
- Overtime
- Attendance compliance

Archetype 3: Project-Based Workforce

Examples:

- Consulting
- IT services
- Agencies

Needs:

- Project timesheets
- Client billing
- Utilization tracking
- Cost allocation

Archetype 4: Field Workforce

Examples:

- Sales
- Service technicians
- Logistics

Needs:

- Geo-attendance
 - Route tracking
 - Visit logs
 - Mobile-first experience
-

My recommendation: Modular Workforce Management

Instead of exposing everything to everyone:

Workforce Management

- Attendance
- Leave
- Timesheets
- Scheduling & Shifts
- Overtime
- Workforce Analytics

But each customer enables only what they need.

Example:

Software company

Workforce Management

- Leave
- Attendance
- Timesheets

Manufacturing plant

Workforce Management

- Attendance
- Leave
- Shifts
- Overtime

Consulting company

Workforce Management

- Leave
- Timesheets
- Project Allocation

Timesheets: Don't make them mandatory

Many products wrongly assume timesheets are universal.

For example:

Employee A (Software Engineer)

Needs:

Project: Customer Portal

Hours: 8

Employee B (Factory Operator)

Needs:

Shift A

Clock In: 06:00

Clock Out: 14:00

No timesheet required.

Therefore:

Attendance = universal

Almost every organization needs some concept of attendance.

Timesheets = optional capability

Enable only when:

- Project tracking
- Client billing
- Cost allocation
- Utilization reporting

are required.

Shifts: Make them a scheduling engine, not a page

A common product mistake is creating a standalone "Shifts" screen.

Instead think of shifts as:

Scheduling Engine

- Fixed shifts
- Rotational shifts
- Split shifts
- On-call shifts
- Flexible schedules

Different industries simply use different configurations.

Manufacturing

Morning

Evening

Night

Hospital

Day
Night
On Call

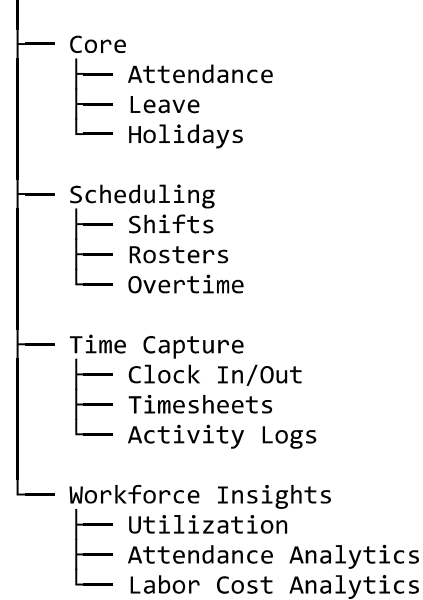
Retail

Store Opening
Store Peak
Store Closing

Same engine.

Product architecture I'd build

Workforce Management



If I were building a new EX portal today

Phase 1 (must-have)

- Leave
- Attendance
- Holidays
- Approvals

Phase 2

- Shift scheduling
- Overtime

- Basic timesheets

Phase 3

- Project-based timesheets
- Workforce planning
- Labor costing
- Advanced analytics

This approach serves a 200-person SaaS company, a 10,000-person manufacturer, and a hospital network using the same platform, with differences driven by configuration rather than separate products. The key principle is: **Attendance and Leave are core; Timesheets and Shifts are optional workforce capabilities that can be turned on based on the customer's operating model.**

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Great. If I were defining the **top-level information architecture** for an Employee Experience Portal, I'd keep it very simple:

Home

- Workforce
- Pay & Benefits
- Performance & Growth
- People
- Requests & Services
- Resources

Workforce

Everything related to "when and how work is performed."

Workforce

- Attendance
- Leave
- Schedule & Shifts (optional)
- Timesheets (optional)
- Overtime (optional)
- Holidays

Pay & Benefits

Pay & Benefits

- Payslips
- Compensation
- Tax
- Insurance
- Reimbursements
- Benefits & Perks

Performance & Growth

Performance & Growth

- Goals
- Reviews
- Learning

- Skills
- Career Development

People

People

- Org Chart
- Employee Directory
- Team Information
- Employee Profiles

Requests & Services

Requests & Services

- HR Helpdesk
- IT Requests
- Facilities Requests
- Approvals

Resources

Resources

- Policies
- Documents
- Forms
- Company Announcements

One principle I'd strongly recommend

Don't expose modules directly because HR thinks in modules, but employees think in tasks.

For example, on the homepage:

- Request Leave
- Clock In
- Submit Timesheet
- View Payslip
- Raise HR Request
- Find a Colleague

The employee shouldn't need to know whether something belongs to "Leave Management," "Time & Attendance," or "Benefits." Those module boundaries are useful for architecture and administration, but the experience should be task-oriented.

A good mental model is:

- **Backend:** modular (Leave, Attendance, Benefits, Performance, etc.)
- **Employee experience:** task-based and role-aware
- **Navigation:** domain-based (Workforce, Pay & Benefits, Growth, Services)

That structure tends to scale well from a few hundred employees to tens of thousands without becoming cluttered.

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Dashboards

For an enterprise Employee Experience Portal, I would not think in terms of **one dashboard**. I'd think in terms of **personas** and **decision-making needs**.

A company with 10,000 employees may ultimately have 20–40 dashboards, but employees only see the few relevant to their role.

1. Employee Dashboard

The default landing page for every employee.

Widgets

- Attendance status
- Today's shift
- Leave balance
- Upcoming holidays
- Team calendar
- Pending approvals (if any)
- Recent payslip
- Benefits summary
- Learning assignments
- Goals progress
- Company announcements
- Quick actions

Quick Actions

- Apply leave
 - Clock in/out
 - Submit timesheet
 - Raise HR ticket
 - Download payslip
 - Update profile
-

2. Manager Dashboard

Focus: Team health and execution.

Team Availability

- Who is on leave
- Who is absent
- Upcoming leave calendar
- Shift coverage gaps

Team Performance

- Goal progress
- Review completion
- Learning completion

Team Operations

- Pending approvals
- Timesheet compliance
- Attendance anomalies

Insights

- Attrition risk
 - Team engagement
 - Overtime trends
-

3. HR Operations Dashboard

Focus: Workforce administration.

Workforce Snapshot

- Total employees
- Active employees
- New joiners
- Exits

Leave Analytics

- Leave utilization
- Sick leave trends
- Leave liability

Attendance Analytics

- Absenteeism
- Late arrivals
- Attendance compliance

Employee Lifecycle

- Onboarding status
- Probation status
- Confirmations

HR Ticket Analytics

- Open requests
 - SLA compliance
 - Resolution time
-

4. HR Business Partner Dashboard

Focus: People strategy.

Organization Health

- Headcount movement
- Internal mobility
- Diversity metrics

Talent Insights

- High performers
- Succession readiness
- Critical roles

Risk Indicators

- Attrition risk
 - Engagement decline
 - Manager effectiveness
-

5. Talent Acquisition Dashboard

Recruiting Funnel

- Applications

- Interviews
- Offers
- Hires

Hiring Metrics

- Time to hire
- Cost per hire
- Offer acceptance rate

Source Analytics

- Referrals
 - Job boards
 - Campus hiring
-

6. Onboarding Dashboard

New Hire Tracking

- Joining this week
- Pending documentation
- Equipment allocation

Completion Metrics

- Onboarding tasks completed
 - Buddy assignments
 - Manager check-ins
-

7. Performance Management Dashboard

Reviews

- Completion rates
- Calibration status

Ratings

- Distribution curves
- High performers
- Low performers

Goals

- Goal completion
 - Department progress
-

8. Learning Dashboard

Learning Progress

- Assigned courses
- Completed courses
- Certifications

Skill Analytics

- Skill gaps
 - Skill coverage
 - Future skill readiness
-

9. Compensation Dashboard

Compensation Overview

- Salary distribution
- Pay bands

Increment Planning

- Budget utilization
- Proposed increments

Equity Analytics

- Pay equity
 - Compensation benchmarking
-

10. Benefits Dashboard

Benefit Utilization

- Insurance enrollment

- Claims summary
- Wellness participation

Cost Analytics

- Employer spend
 - Benefit adoption
-

11. Workforce Management Dashboard

Attendance

- Present
- Absent
- Late

Leave

- Planned leave
- Unplanned leave

Workforce Coverage

- Shift coverage
 - Staffing shortages
-

12. Shift Operations Dashboard

Important for manufacturing, retail, healthcare.

Shift Status

- Active shifts
- Coverage gaps

Shift Metrics

- Overtime
 - Shift swaps
 - Compliance issues
-

13. Timesheet Dashboard

For consulting, IT services, agencies.

Compliance

- Submitted
- Pending
- Rejected

Utilization

- Billable hours
- Non-billable hours

Project Allocation

- Hours by project
 - Cost by project
-

14. Service Desk Dashboard

Ticket Metrics

- Open tickets
- Resolution SLA

Category Trends

- HR
 - IT
 - Facilities
-

15. Employee Engagement Dashboard

Survey Analytics

- Participation rate
- Engagement score

Sentiment

- Team sentiment
 - Department sentiment
-

16. DEI Dashboard

Diversity Metrics

- Gender diversity
- Representation by level

Inclusion Metrics

- Hiring diversity
 - Promotion diversity
-

17. Safety & Compliance Dashboard

Common in manufacturing and healthcare.

Compliance

- Mandatory trainings
- Policy acknowledgements

Safety

- Incidents
 - Near misses
-

18. Executive Dashboard

The most important dashboard.

CEO/CHRO/CFO shouldn't see operational details.

Workforce Overview

- Total headcount
- Growth trend

Talent

- Attrition
- Hiring progress

Productivity

- Utilization
- Goal achievement

Financials

- Workforce cost
- Benefit cost

Risks

- Critical vacancies
 - Compliance alerts
-

19. Department Head Dashboard

Headcount

- Current
- Planned

Performance

- Goal progress

Financial

- Labor cost
 - Overtime cost
-

20. Payroll Dashboard

Payroll Processing

- Payroll status
- Exceptions

Deductions

- Tax
- Benefits

Compliance

- Statutory filings
-

If I were building v1

I would start with only **6 dashboards**:

1. Employee Dashboard
2. Manager Dashboard
3. HR Operations Dashboard
4. Workforce Management Dashboard
5. Service Desk Dashboard
6. Executive Dashboard

Then add specialized dashboards (Learning, Performance, Benefits, Recruiting, DEI, Payroll, etc.) as separate products mature.

A useful product strategy is to build a **dashboard framework** rather than dozens of hardcoded dashboards. Define reusable widgets (Headcount, Leave Trends, Approval Queue, Attrition, Learning Progress, Cost Metrics, etc.) and compose persona-specific dashboards from those widgets. That scales much better and avoids maintaining 20+ separate dashboard implementations.

Finance is often overlooked in Employee Experience portals, but in large enterprises the **Finance persona is one of the most important consumers of workforce data** because people costs are typically the largest operating expense.

I'd create a dedicated **Finance & Workforce Cost Dashboard** and a few specialized sub-dashboards.

1. CFO Dashboard

Focus: "What is our workforce costing us?"

Workforce Cost Snapshot

- Total payroll cost
- Total benefits cost
- Total contractor cost
- Total overtime cost
- Total workforce cost

Trends

- Monthly payroll trend
- Cost per employee
- Cost per department
- Cost per location

Risks

- Budget overruns
- Overtime spikes

- Hiring plan variance

Executive KPIs

Headcount
Labor Cost
Revenue per Employee
Labor Cost %
Attrition Cost
Vacancy Cost

2. Payroll Operations Dashboard

Focus: payroll execution.

Payroll Run Status

- Employees processed
- Pending employees
- Exceptions
- Failed payroll records

Payroll Components

- Basic pay
- Variable pay
- Bonuses
- Deductions

Compliance

- Tax deductions
- PF contributions
- ESI contributions
- Statutory filings

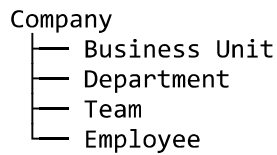
Exception Management

- Missing attendance
 - Missing timesheets
 - Missing bank details
 - Payroll holds
-

3. Workforce Cost Analytics Dashboard

This is extremely valuable.

Cost by Organization



Cost Categories

- Salary
- Benefits
- Overtime
- Bonuses
- Contractors

Insights

- Cost center analysis
 - Budget vs actual
 - Variance analysis
-

4. Overtime Cost Dashboard

Important for manufacturing, retail, logistics, healthcare.

Metrics

- Overtime hours
- Overtime spend
- Overtime by shift
- Overtime by location

Alerts

- Excess overtime
 - Compliance violations
 - Cost spikes
-

5. Leave Liability Dashboard

Finance teams often care more about this than HR.

Metrics

- Accrued leave balance
- Leave encashment liability
- Liability by department
- Liability trend

Forecasting

- Expected encashment
 - Future liability exposure
-

6. Hiring Cost Dashboard

For Finance + TA leadership.

Hiring Metrics

- Cost per hire
- Agency fees
- Recruitment spend
- Referral payouts

Hiring Budget

- Budget vs actual
 - Open requisition cost
-

7. Contractor & Vendor Workforce Dashboard

Many enterprises spend heavily on non-employees.

Metrics

- Contractor count
- Contractor spend
- Vendor-wise spend

- Utilization
-

8. Project Cost Dashboard

Important for IT services, consulting, engineering firms.

Project Financials

- Resource cost
- Billable cost
- Non-billable cost
- Margin

Resource Allocation

- Cost by project
 - Cost by customer
 - Utilization
-

9. Benefits Cost Dashboard

Cost Metrics

- Insurance premiums
- Wellness spend
- Reimbursement spend

Utilization

- Enrollment rates
 - Claims trends
 - Cost per employee
-

10. Headcount Budget Dashboard

This becomes critical during annual planning.

Planned vs Actual

Metric	Planned	Actual
Headcount		

Metric	Planned	Actual
Cost		
Hiring		
Attrition		

Forecast

- End-of-year headcount
- End-of-year payroll
- Budget variance

11. Finance Approval Dashboard

For shared service centers.

Pending Approvals

- Reimbursements
- Relocation claims
- Joining bonuses
- Retention bonuses
- Travel claims

SLA Tracking

- Approval time
- Bottlenecks
- Escalations

If you're building a modern EX portal

I would create a dedicated domain:

Finance & Workforce Cost
└─ Payroll
└─ Workforce Cost
└─ Budgeting
└─ Leave Liability
└─ Benefits Cost
└─ Hiring Cost
└─ Project Cost
└─ Forecasting

The most powerful dashboard

If I had to build only one finance dashboard, it would be:

Workforce Cost Command Center

Combining:

- Headcount
- Payroll
- Benefits
- Overtime
- Contractors
- Hiring spend
- Budget variance
- Forecasted workforce cost

This becomes the single source of truth for CFOs, Finance Controllers, and FP&A teams because it answers the key question:

"How much are people costing us today, why, and what will they cost us over the next 3–12 months?"

That dashboard often delivers more executive value than traditional HR dashboards because workforce costs typically account for 50–80% of operating expenses in knowledge-based organizations.

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The trend in 2025–2026 is actually moving **away from dashboard-centric experiences** toward **action-centric, AI-assisted experiences**.

Optimize for:

"How quickly can a user complete their job?"
not
"How many charts can I show?"

Trend 1: Dashboard → Command Center

Old:

Headcount: 10,432
Attrition: 12%
Leave Rate: 4%

User looks at numbers and leaves.

Modern:

Your Team Today

2 employees on leave
1 timesheet pending
3 approvals waiting
1 high-risk attrition alert

[Approve]
[View Risk]
[Remind Employee]

The dashboard immediately drives action.

This is what managers want.

Trend 2: AI Summary Cards

Instead of showing 20 charts:

Good Morning, Sarah.

Your team attendance is 98%.

Attendance improved by 4% compared to last month.

3 employees are approaching burnout thresholds due to sustained overtime.

Recommended actions:

- Review workload
- Schedule manager check-ins

Executives especially love this.

They don't want charts.
They want conclusions.

Trend 3: Personalized Homepages

Different users see different experiences.

Employee

Clock In
Apply Leave
View Payslip

Manager

Approve Leave
Review Timesheets
Team Availability

HR

Onboarding Status
Attrition Risk
Policy Compliance

Finance

Payroll Exceptions
Workforce Cost
Budget Variance

One portal.

Many experiences.

Trend 4: Feed-Based UX

Borrowed from consumer apps.

Example:

Today

✓ Payroll completed

✓ 5 employees joined

⚠ 3 approvals pending

⚠ Leave balance policy updated

✓ Performance cycle launched

Instead of making users search dashboards.

Trend 5: Predictive Analytics

Current dashboards tell you:

Attrition = 12%

Modern dashboards tell you:

Attrition likely to increase
in Engineering next quarter.

Predicted risk:
14 employees.

Same for:

- Leave spikes
 - Overtime
 - Hiring delays
 - Payroll anomalies
 - Budget overruns
-

Trend 6: Exception-Driven Dashboards

This is huge.

Users don't care about normal situations.

They care about problems.

Instead of:

10,000 employees processed

Show:

25 payroll exceptions

Instead of:

Attendance 97%

Show:

37 attendance anomalies

This dramatically increases engagement.

Trend 7: Embedded Workflows

Best-in-class products don't stop at insights.

Example:

12 pending leave approvals

[Approve All]

or

Payroll variance detected

[Investigate]

The dashboard becomes a work surface.

Not a reporting page.

Trend 8: Mobile-First Dashboards

Historically HR dashboards were desktop-only.

Now:

Employee

Must be mobile-first.

Clock In
Leave Balance
Payslip

Manager

Approvals
Team Status

Anything beyond that loses engagement.

Trend 9: Cross-Functional Metrics

The newest trend is breaking HR silos.

Example:

HR sees

Attrition

Finance sees

Attrition Cost

Business Head sees

Revenue Impact

Same event.

Different perspectives.

Trend 10: Conversational Dashboards (Fastest Growing)

Instead of navigating:

Workforce Dashboard
↓
Attendance Report
↓
Filters
↓
Export

User asks:

Show employees with overtime above 20 hours this month.

or

Why is payroll cost up 8%?

AI generates:

- Answer
- Chart
- Recommended actions

This is where platforms are heading.

If I were designing an EX portal in 2026

I would make the homepage:

Good Morning, Priya

Today

- 2 approvals pending
- Team attendance 98%
- Payroll closes in 3 days

Recommended Actions

- Review overtime spike
- Approve leave requests

Quick Actions

[Apply Leave]
[Approve Requests]

[View Payslip]
[Raise Ticket]

AI Assistant

Ask anything about workforce data...

Then keep detailed dashboards one click away.

Engagement formula

The dashboards that get used most consistently have:

1. **Personalization** (relevant to the user)
2. **Actions** (not just metrics)
3. **Alerts & exceptions**
4. **AI-generated insights**
5. **Embedded workflows**
6. **Mobile usability**
7. **Conversational search**

A useful rule of thumb:

Every widget should answer one of three questions:

- What needs my attention?
- What action should I take?
- What decision should I make?

If a widget answers none of those, it usually becomes dashboard decoration and engagement drops quickly.

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Need to look at these things/points while doing the final set of enhancements.

Regards
KK